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Medicament delivery device and actuation mechanism for a drug delivery device

Abstract

Described is an actuation mechanism for a medicament delivery device having a needle with a distal tip. The actuation mechanism comprises an outer sleeve telescopically relative to the delivery device and an inner sleeve telescopically arranged relative to the outer sleeve. The outer sleeve is axially translatable relative to the delivery device, and the inner sleeve is axially translatable relative to the outer sleeve. In a first state, the inner sleeve protrudes distally from the outer sleeve and the outer sleeve protrudes distally from the delivery device. In a second state, the inner sleeve is contained within the outer sleeve. Movement of the outer sleeve proximally relative to the delivery device in the second state initiates delivery of a medicament in the delivery device.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) The present application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/892,047, filed Jun. 3, 2020, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 15/177,948, filed Jun. 9, 2016, now U.S. Pat. No. 10,675,408, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 14/346,228, filed Mar. 20, 2014, now U.S. Pat. No. 9,364,617, which is a U.S. National Phase Application pursuant to 35 U.S.C. § 371 of International Application No. PCT/EP2012/068572 filed Sep. 20, 2012, which claims priority to European Patent Application No. 11182632.7 filed Sep. 23, 2011. The entire disclosure contents of these applications are herewith incorporated by reference into the present application.

FIELD OF INVENTION

(1) The invention relates to a medicament delivery device and an actuation mechanism for a medicament delivery device.

BACKGROUND

(2) Conventional medicament delivery devices containing a selected dose of a medicament are well-known devices for administering the medicament to a patient. A conventional delivery device comprises a needle to administer the medicament. Safety devices for covering a needle of the delivery device before and after use are also well known. In a conventional safety device, a needle shield is moved either manually or automatically (i.e., by spring) to cover the needle.

(3) A specific type of a medicament delivery device is an autoinjector, which equipped with an actuation button to actuate automatic delivery of the medicament. To administer the medicament, the autoinjector is pressed against an injection site, which retracts the needle shield. When the actuation button is pressed, the needle is inserted into the injection site and the medicament is administered. The conventional delivery device, thus, requires two acts—pressing of the delivery device to injection site and pressing the actuation button. It may be difficult to perform either or both of these acts when the patient/operator has lessened dexterity, e.g., due to age, disability, illness, sensory deficiency, etc.

(4) Other conventional delivery devices are actuated upon contact with the injection site. These devices are pressed against the injection site, which retracts the needle shield, and pressed with enhanced force to initiate delivery of the medicament. However, patients may be confused by these types of delivery devices, because there is no actuation button.

SUMMARY

(5) It is an object of the present invention to provide an actuation mechanism for a medicament delivery device for easy and safe medicament delivery.

(6) In an exemplary embodiment, an actuation mechanism for a medicament delivery device has a needle with a distal tip. The actuation mechanism comprises an outer sleeve telescopically relative to the delivery device and an inner sleeve telescopically arranged relative to the outer sleeve. The outer sleeve is axially translatable relative to the delivery device, and the inner sleeve is axially translatable relative to the outer sleeve. In a first state, the inner sleeve protrudes distally from the outer sleeve and the outer sleeve protrudes distally from the delivery device. In a second state, the inner sleeve is contained within the outer sleeve. Movement of the outer sleeve proximally relative to the delivery device in the second state initiates delivery of a medicament in the delivery device.

(7) In an exemplary embodiment, the inner sleeve and the outer sleeve have different colors or

indicia.

(8) In an exemplary embodiment, the actuation mechanism further comprises a first spring element biasing the inner sleeve in a distal direction relative to the outer sleeve. The actuation mechanism further comprises a second spring element biasing the outer sleeve in a distal direction relative to the delivery device. The second spring element is a harder compression spring than the first spring element.

(9) In an exemplary embodiment, the outer sleeve is positionally fixed relative to the delivery device in the first state. The inner sleeve engages the outer sleeve in the second state. The inner sleeve includes a latch adapted to engage a recess or opening in the outer sleeve. The outer sleeve includes a latch adapted to engage a recess or opening in the inner sleeve.

(10) In an exemplary embodiment, when in a third state, the inner sleeve is locked relative to the outer sleeve and the outer sleeve is locked relative to the delivery device.

(11) In an exemplary embodiment, a drug delivery device comprises an actuation mechanism according to any one of the exemplary embodiments described above, and further includes a needle having a distal tip. In the first state, the inner sleeve and/or the outer sleeve cover the distal tip, and in the second state, the distal tip is adapted to protrude distally relative to the outer sleeve. In the third state, the inner sleeve and/or the outer sleeve cover the distal tip of the needle.

(12) The term “drug” or “medicament”, as used herein, means a pharmaceutical formulation containing at least one pharmaceutically active compound, wherein in one embodiment the pharmaceutically active compound has a molecular weight up to 1500 Da and/or is a peptide, a protein, a polysaccharide, a vaccine, a DNA, a RNA, an enzyme, an antibody or a fragment thereof, a hormone or an oligonucleotide, or a mixture of the above-mentioned pharmaceutically active compound, wherein in a further embodiment the pharmaceutically active compound is useful for the treatment and/or prophylaxis of diabetes mellitus or complications associated with diabetes mellitus such as diabetic retinopathy, thromboembolism disorders such as deep vein or pulmonary thromboembolism, acute coronary syndrome (ACS), angina, myocardial infarction, cancer, macular degeneration, inflammation, hay fever, atherosclerosis and/or rheumatoid arthritis, wherein in a further embodiment the pharmaceutically active compound comprises at least one peptide for the treatment and/or prophylaxis of diabetes mellitus or complications associated with diabetes mellitus such as diabetic retinopathy, wherein in a further embodiment the pharmaceutically active compound comprises at least one human insulin or a human insulin analogue or derivative, glucagon-like peptide (GLP-1) or an analogue or derivative thereof, or exendin-3 or exendin-4 or an analogue or derivative of exendin-3 or exendin-4.

(13) Insulin analogues are for example Gly(A21), Arg(B31), Arg(B32) human insulin; Lys(B3), Glu(B29) human insulin; Lys(B28), Pro(B29) human insulin; Asp(B28) human insulin; human insulin, wherein proline in position B28 is replaced by Asp, Lys, Leu, Val or Ala and wherein in position B29 Lys may be replaced by Pro; Ala(B26) human insulin; Des(B28-B30) human insulin; Des(B27) human insulin and Des(B30) human insulin.

(14) Insulin derivatives are for example B29-N-myristoyl-des(B30) human insulin; B29-N-palmitoyl-des(B30) human insulin; B29-N-myristoyl human insulin; B29-N-palmitoyl human insulin; B28-N-myristoyl LysB28ProB29 human insulin; B28-N-palmitoyl-LysB28ProB29 human insulin; B30-N-myristoyl-ThrB29LysB30 human insulin; B30-N-palmitoyl-ThrB29LysB30 human insulin; B29-N-(N-palmitoyl-Y-glutamyl)-des(B30) human insulin; B29-N-(N-lithocholyl-Y-glutamyl)-des(B30) human insulin; B29-N-(ω -carboxyheptadecanoyl)-des(B30) human insulin and B29-N-(ω -carboxyheptadecanoyl) human insulin.

(15) Exendin-4 for example means Exendin-4(1-39), a peptide of the sequence H-His-Gly-Glu-Gly-Thr-Phe-Thr-Ser-Asp-Leu-Ser-Lys-Gln-Met-Glu-Glu-Glu-Ala-Val-Arg-Leu-Phe-11e-Glu-Trp-Leu-Lys-Asn-Gly-Gly-Pro-Ser-Ser-Gly-Ala-Pro-Pro-Ser-NH₂.

(16) Exendin-4 derivatives are for example selected from the following list of compounds: H-(Lys)4-des Pro36, des Pro37 Exendin-4(1-39)-NH₂, H-(Lys)5-des Pro36, des Pro37 Exendin-4(1-

39)-NH₂, des Pro36 Exendin-4(1-39), des Pro36 [Asp28] Exendin-4(1-39), des Pro36 [IsoAsp28] Exendin-4(1-39), des Pro36 [Met(O)14, Asp28] Exendin-4(1-39), des Pro36 [Met(O)14, IsoAsp28] Exendin-4(1-39), des Pro36 [Trp(02)25, Asp28] Exendin-4(1-39), des Pro36 [Trp(02)25, IsoAsp28] Exendin-4(1-39), des Pro36 [Met(O)14 Trp(02)25, Asp28] Exendin-4(1-39), des Pro36 [Met(O)14 Trp(02)25, IsoAsp28] Exendin-4(1-39); or des Pro36 [Asp28] Exendin-4(1-39), des Pro36 [IsoAsp28] Exendin-4(1-39), des Pro36 [Met(O)14, Asp28] Exendin-4(1-39), des Pro36 [Met(O)14, IsoAsp28] Exendin-4(1-39), des Pro36 [Trp(02)25, Asp28] Exendin-4(1-39), des Pro36 [Trp(02)25, IsoAsp28] Exendin-4(1-39), des Pro36 [Met(O)14 Trp(02)25, Asp28] Exendin-4(1-39), des Pro36 [Met(O)14 Trp(02)25, IsoAsp28] Exendin-4(1-39), wherein the group-Lys6-NH₂ may be bound to the C-terminus of the Exendin-4 derivative; or an Exendin-4 derivative of the sequence des Pro36 Exendin-4(1-39)-Lys6-NH₂ (AVE0010), H-(Lys)6-des Pro36 [Asp28] Exendin-4(1-39)-Lys6-NH₂, des Asp28 Pro36, Pro37, Pro38 Exendin-4(1-39)-NH₂, -(Lys)6-des Pro36, Pro38 [Asp28] Exendin-4(1-39)-NH₂, H-Asn-(Glu)5des Pro36, Pro37, Pro38 [Asp28] Exendin-4(1-39)-NH₂, des Pro36, Pro37, Pro38 [Asp28] Exendin-4(1-39)-(Lys)6-NH₂, H-(Lys)6-des Pro36, Pro37, Pro38 [Asp28] Exendin-4(1-39)-(Lys)6-NH₂, H-Asn-(Glu)5-des Pro36, Pro37, Pro38 [Asp28] Exendin-4(1-39)-(Lys)6-NH₂, H-(Lys)6-des Pro36 [Trp(02)25, Asp28] Exendin-4(1-39)-Lys6-NH₂, H-des Asp28 Pro36, Pro37, Pro38 [Trp(02)25] Exendin-4(1-39)-NH₂, H-(Lys)6-des Pro36, Pro37, Pro38 [Trp(02)25, Asp28] Exendin-4(1-39)-NH₂, H-Asn-(Glu)5-des Pro36, Pro37, Pro38 [Trp(02)25, Asp28] Exendin-4(1-39)-(Lys)6-NH₂, H-(Lys)6-des Pro36, Pro37, Pro38 [Trp(02)25, Asp28] Exendin-4(1-39)-(Lys)6-NH₂, H-Asn-(Glu)5-des Pro36, Pro37, Pro38 [Trp(02)25, Asp28] Exendin-4(1-39)-(Lys)6-NH₂, H-(Lys)6-des Pro36 [Met(O)14, Asp28] Exendin-4(1-39)-Lys6-NH₂, des Met(O)14 Asp28 Pro36, Pro37, Pro38 Exendin-4(1-39)-NH₂, H-(Lys)6-des Pro36, Pro37, Pro38 [Met(O)14, Asp28] Exendin-4(1-39)-NH₂, H-Asn-(Glu)5-des Pro36, Pro37, Pro38 [Met(O)14, Asp28] Exendin-4(1-39)-NH₂, des Pro36, Pro37, Pro38 [Met(O)14, Asp28] Exendin-4(1-39)-(Lys)6-NH₂, H-(Lys)6-des Pro36, Pro37, Pro38 [Met(O)14, Asp28] Exendin-4(1-39)-(Lys)6-NH₂, H-Asn-(Glu)5 des Pro36, Pro37, Pro38 [Met(O)14, Asp28] Exendin-4(1-39)-(Lys)6-NH₂, H-Lys6-des Pro36 [Met(O)14, Trp(02)25, Asp28] Exendin-4(1-39)-Lys6-NH₂, H-des Asp28 Pro36, Pro37, Pro38 [Met(O)14, Trp(02)25] Exendin-4(1-39)-NH₂, H-(Lys)6-des Pro36, Pro37, Pro38 [Met(O)14, Asp28] Exendin-4(1-39)-NH₂, H-Asn-(Glu)5-des Pro36, Pro37, Pro38 [Met(O)14, Trp(02)25, Asp28] Exendin-4(1-39)-NH₂, des Pro36, Pro37, Pro38 [Met(O)14, Trp(02)25, Asp28] Exendin-4(1-39)-(Lys)6-NH₂, H-(Lys)6-des Pro36, Pro37, Pro38 [Met(O)14, Trp(02)25, Asp28] Exendin-4(S1-39)-(Lys)6-NH₂, H-Asn-(Glu)5-des Pro36, Pro37, Pro38 [Met(O)14, Trp(02)25, Asp28] Exendin-4(1-39)-(Lys)6-NH₂; or a pharmaceutically acceptable salt or solvate of any one of the afore-mentioned Exendin-4 derivative.

(17) Hormones are for example hypophysis hormones or hypothalamus hormones or regulatory active peptides and their antagonists as listed in Rote Liste, ed. 2008, Chapter 50, such as Gonadotropine (Follitropin, Lutropin, Choriongonadotropin, Menotropin), Somatotropine (Somatotropin), Desmopressin, Terlipressin, Gonadorelin, Triptorelin, Leuprorelin, Buserelin, Nafarelin, Goserelin.

(18) A polysaccharide is for example a glucosaminoglycane, a hyaluronic acid, a heparin, a low molecular weight heparin or an ultra low molecular weight heparin or a derivative thereof, or a sulphated, e.g. a poly-sulphated form of the above-mentioned polysaccharides, and/or a pharmaceutically acceptable salt thereof. An example of a pharmaceutically acceptable salt of a poly-sulphated low molecular weight heparin is enoxaparin sodium.

(19) Antibodies are globular plasma proteins (~150 kDa) that are also known as immunoglobulins, which share a basic structure. As they have sugar chains added to amino acid residues, they are glycoproteins. The basic functional unit of each antibody is an immunoglobulin (Ig) monomer (containing only one Ig unit); secreted antibodies can also be dimeric with two Ig units as with IgA, tetrameric with four Ig units like teleost fish IgM, or pentameric with five Ig units, like mammalian

IgM.

(20) The Ig monomer is a “Y”-shaped molecule that consists of four polypeptide chains; two identical heavy chains and two identical light chains connected by disulfide bonds between cysteine residues. Each heavy chain is about 440 amino acids long; each light chain is about 220 amino acids long. Heavy and light chains each contain intrachain disulfide bonds which stabilize their folding. Each chain is composed of structural domains called Ig domains. These domains contain about 70-110 amino acids and are classified into different categories (for example, variable or V, and constant or C) according to their size and function. They have a characteristic immunoglobulin fold in which two β sheets create a “sandwich” shape, held together by interactions between conserved cysteines and other charged amino acids.

(21) There are five types of mammalian Ig heavy chain denoted by α , δ , ϵ , γ , and μ . The type of heavy chain present defines the isotype of antibody; these chains are found in IgA, IgD, IgE, IgG, and IgM antibodies, respectively.

(22) Distinct heavy chains differ in size and composition; α and γ contain approximately 450 amino acids and δ approximately 500 amino acids, while μ and ϵ have approximately 550 amino acids. Each heavy chain has two regions, the constant region (C.sub.H) and the variable region (V.sub.H). In one species, the constant region is essentially identical in all antibodies of the same isotype, but differs in antibodies of different isotypes. Heavy chains γ , α and δ have a constant region composed of three tandem Ig domains, and a hinge region for added flexibility; heavy chains μ and ϵ have a constant region composed of four immunoglobulin domains. The variable region of the heavy chain differs in antibodies produced by different B cells, but is the same for all antibodies produced by a single B cell or B cell clone. The variable region of each heavy chain is approximately 110 amino acids long and is composed of a single Ig domain.

(23) In mammals, there are two types of immunoglobulin light chain denoted by λ and κ . A light chain has two successive domains: one constant domain (CL) and one variable domain (VL). The approximate length of a light chain is 211 to 217 amino acids. Each antibody contains two light chains that are always identical; only one type of light chain, κ or λ , is present per antibody in mammals.

(24) Although the general structure of all antibodies is very similar, the unique property of a given antibody is determined by the variable (V) regions, as detailed above. More specifically, variable loops, three each on the light (VL) and three on the heavy (VH) chain, are responsible for binding to the antigen, i.e. for its antigen specificity. These loops are referred to as the Complementarity Determining Regions (CDRs). Because CDRs from both VH and VL domains contribute to the antigen-binding site, it is the combination of the heavy and the light chains, and not either alone, that determines the final antigen specificity.

(25) An “antibody fragment” contains at least one antigen binding fragment as defined above and exhibits essentially the same function and specificity as the complete antibody of which the fragment is derived from. Limited proteolytic digestion with papain cleaves the Ig prototype into three fragments. Two identical amino terminal fragments, each containing one entire L chain and about half an H chain, are the antigen binding fragments (Fab). The third fragment, similar in size but containing the carboxyl terminal half of both heavy chains with their interchain disulfide bond, is the crystallizable fragment (Fc). The Fc contains carbohydrates, complement-binding, and FcR-binding sites. Limited pepsin digestion yields a single $F(ab')_2$ fragment containing both Fab pieces and the hinge region, including the H-H interchain disulfide bond. $F(ab')_2$ is divalent for antigen binding. The disulfide bond of $F(ab')_2$ may be cleaved in order to obtain Fab'. Moreover, the variable regions of the heavy and light chains can be fused together to form a single chain variable fragment (scFv).

(26) Pharmaceutically acceptable salts are for example acid addition salts and basic salts. Acid addition salts are e.g. HCl or HBr salts. Basic salts are e.g. salts having a cation selected from alkali or alkaline, e.g. Na^+ , or K^+ , or Ca^{2+} , or an ammonium ion $N^+(R1)(R2)(R3)(R4)$, wherein R1 to

R4 independently of each other mean: hydrogen, an optionally substituted C1-C6-alkyl group, an optionally substituted C2-C6-alkenyl group, an optionally substituted C6-C10-aryl group, or an optionally substituted C6-C10-heteroaryl group. Further examples of pharmaceutically acceptable salts are described in "Remington's Pharmaceutical Sciences" 17. ed. Alfonso R. Gennaro (Ed.), Mark Publishing Company, Easton, Pa., U.S.A., 1985 and in Encyclopedia of Pharmaceutical Technology.

(27) Pharmaceutically acceptable solvates are for example hydrates.

(28) Further scope of applicability of the present invention will become apparent from the detailed description given hereinafter. However, it should be understood that the detailed description and specific examples, while indicating preferred embodiments of the invention, are given by way of illustration only, since various changes and modifications within the spirit and scope of the invention will become apparent to those skilled in the art from this detailed description.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The present invention will become more fully understood from the detailed description given hereinbelow and the accompanying drawings, which are given by way of illustration only, and thus, are not limitative of the present invention, and wherein:

(2) FIG. 1 shows an exemplary embodiment of a medicament delivery device before use, and

(3) FIG. 2 shows an exemplary embodiment of a medicament delivery device during use.

(4) Corresponding parts are marked with the same reference symbols in all figures.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(5) FIGS. 1 and 2 show an exemplary embodiment of a medicament delivery device **1** before and during administration of a medicament to a patient, respectively. Those of skill in the art will understand that the patient may be a human or animal. In the exemplary embodiment, the delivery device **1** is an autoinjector designed to automatically deliver a dose of a medicament by means of a needle **2** upon sleeve-driven actuation. Those of skill in the art will understand that the delivery device **1** may be a pen injector, a syringe, an infusion device, etc.

(6) An exemplary embodiment of a sleeve-driven actuation mechanism comprises a housing **5**, an inner sleeve **3** and an outer sleeve **4** telescopically arranged on the inner sleeve **3**. The inner sleeve **3** and the outer sleeve **4** are axially translatable relative to each other and relative to the housing **5**. The inner sleeve **3** covers the needle **2** before and after use of the delivery device **1** to prevent accidental needlestick injuries. The outer sleeve **4** serves to actuate a delivery mechanism in the delivery device **1**. The sleeves **3**, **4** may be arranged telescopically and substantially shaped as hollow cylinders with open proximal ends. The outer sleeve **4** has an open distal end **4.1** for accommodating the inner sleeve **3**. A distal end **3.1** of the inner sleeve **3** may be opened or have a cover face with a central aperture for accommodating projection of the needle **2**. In an exemplary embodiment, the distal end **3.1** of the inner sleeve **3** may be planar or curved.

(7) FIG. 1 shows an exemplary embodiment of the delivery device **1** in a first state, e.g., prior to use on an injection site **7**. In the first state, the outer sleeve **4** projects distally out of the housing **5**, and the inner sleeve **3** projects distally out of the outer sleeve **4**. In the first state, the sleeves **3**, **4** cover a distal needle tip **2.1** of the needle **2** and thus prevent accidental needlestick injuries. For example, in the first state, the distal needle tip **2.1** of the needle **2** may be proximal of the distal end **4.1** of the outer sleeve **4**.

(8) In an exemplary embodiment, in the first state, the inner sleeve **3** may be axially translatable relative to the outer sleeve **4**, but the outer sleeve **4** may be locked relative to the housing **5**. Thus, the inner sleeve **3** may be repeatedly retracted into the outer sleeve **4** a predetermined distance without triggering delivery of the medicament. This may prevent inadvertent triggering of the

delivery device **1**, allowing for realignment of the delivery device **1** on a different injection site.

(9) In an exemplary embodiment, the inner sleeve **3** may be biased in the first state by a first spring element, and the outer sleeve **4** may be biased in the first state by a second spring element.

(10) FIG. **2** shows an exemplary embodiment of the delivery device **1** in a second state, e.g., during use. When the delivery device **1** is pressed against an injection site, the inner sleeve **3** may be pushed into an intermediate position in which it is fully contained inside the outer sleeve **4**, and the distal end **4.1** of the outer sleeve **4** touches the injection site **7**. When the distal end **3.1** of the inner sleeve **3** is in a same plane as the distal end **4.1** of the outer sleeve **4**, the inner sleeve **3** and the outer sleeve **4** may be coupled together so that further pressing of the delivery device **1** against the injection site **7** causes the sleeves **3**, **4** to move together proximally relative to the housing **5**. For example, the inner sleeve **3** may engage the outer sleeve **4** when the inner sleeve **3** has attained a predetermined axial position relative to the outer sleeve **4**.

(11) In an exemplary embodiment, when the inner sleeve **3** engages the outer sleeve **4**, the needle **2** may be inserted into the injection site **7** and the medicament may be delivered. In another exemplary embodiment, when the outer sleeve **4** is pressed against the injection site **7**, the needle **2** may be inserted into the injection site **7** and the medicament may be delivered.

(12) A tactile feedback may be provided in the form of resistance. For example, the first spring element associated with the inner sleeve **3** may require less force to compress than the second spring element associated with the outer sleeve **4**. Thus, an increased force may be necessary to cause the outer sleeve **4** to move proximally, axially relative to the housing **5**. This has the advantage that the patient can clearly distinguish the two steps of the process and thus removes a potential patient's feeling of insecurity concerning the injection process. A further advantage of the actuation mechanism according to the invention is that the different pressures for the two steps of the process can be realized more easily because they are induced automatically by coupling the sleeves to different compression springs. Of course, in alternative embodiments, the compression springs may be replaced by other tensioning members.

(13) In an exemplary embodiment, the sleeves **3**, **4** have different colors or indicia. For example, different colors emphasize the different functions of the sleeves **3**, **4** and thus distinguish the two steps of the injection process even more clearly.

(14) After the injection process, the delivery device **1** is withdrawn from the injection site **7**. When force is removed from the sleeves **3**, **4**, the compression springs relax and shift the sleeves **3**, **4** distally toward the first state so that they again cover the needle **2**. Thus, advantageously accidental needlestick injuries are prevented after use of the delivery device **1**.

(15) In a preferred extension of the invention, the delivery device **1** additionally comprises additionally a locking mechanism, which locks the position of the inner sleeve **3** and/or the position of the outer sleeve **4** relative to each other and/or the housing **5**. The locking mechanism may ensure that the inner sleeve **3** and/or outer sleeve **4** cover the distal needle tip **2.1**. This advantageously further reduces the risk of accidental needlestick injuries after using the delivery device **1**.

(16) For instance, the locking mechanism may comprise at least one latch member of the inner sleeve **3** or the outer sleeve **4** and a corresponding groove located in the housing **5** of the drug delivery device **1**, the groove being adapted to receive the latch member. Alternatively, the latch member may be part of the housing **5** and the groove may be located in a sleeve **3**, **4**.

(17) Those of skill in the art will understand that modifications (additions and/or removals) of various components of the apparatuses, methods and/or systems and embodiments described herein may be made without departing from the full scope and spirit of the present invention, which encompass such modifications and any and all equivalents thereof.

Claims

1. An auto-injector comprising: a housing; a first sleeve comprising a first indicator of a first color, the first sleeve configured to move relative to the housing while remaining concentric to the housing; and a second sleeve comprising a second indicator of a second color different than the first color, the first sleeve configured to move relative to the second sleeve while remaining concentric to the second sleeve, the first sleeve extending axially from the second sleeve, and a distal end of the second sleeve being larger than a distal end of the first sleeve, wherein the auto-injector is configured such that when the auto-injector is pressed against an injection site, the distal end of the second sleeve touches the injection site, and a movement of the first sleeve relative to the housing is required before the auto-injector can insert a needle into the injection site and deliver a medicament, wherein the first indicator and the second indicator are indicative of an injection process of the auto-injector, and the auto-injector is configured such that after the injection process, the auto-injector can be withdrawn from the injection site such that a compression spring relaxes to cause the needle to be covered by the auto-injector, and wherein the housing comprises a latch member, and the first sleeve comprises a groove configured to receive the latch member to lock the first sleeve in a position relative to the housing in which a distal needle tip of the needle is covered by the auto-injector.
2. The auto-injector of claim 1, wherein the auto-injector is configured to provide a tactile feedback in a form of a resistance for allowing a patient to distinguish two steps of the injection process.
3. The auto-injector of claim 1, wherein a distal end of the auto-injector defines a distal opening and has an exterior tapered profile, the exterior tapered profile having a dimension that varies along a longitudinal axis of the auto-injector.
4. The auto-injector of claim 1, comprising a syringe containing the medicament and comprising the needle, wherein the medicament comprises a glucagon-like peptide-1 (GLP-1) or an analogue or derivative thereof.
5. An auto-injector comprising: a housing; a first sleeve comprising a first indicator of a first color, the first sleeve configured to move relative to the housing while remaining concentric to the housing; and a second sleeve comprising a second indicator of a second color different than the first color, the first sleeve configured to move relative to the second sleeve while remaining concentric to the second sleeve, the first sleeve extending axially from the second sleeve, and a distal end of the second sleeve being larger than a distal end of the first sleeve, wherein the auto-injector is configured such that when the auto-injector is pressed against an injection site, the distal end of the second sleeve touches the injection site, and a movement of the first sleeve relative to the housing allows the auto-injector to insert a needle into the injection site and deliver a medicament, wherein the first indicator and the second indicator are indicative of an injection process of the auto-injector, and wherein the housing comprises a latch member, and the first sleeve comprises a groove configured to receive the latch member to lock the first sleeve in a position relative to the housing in which a distal needle tip of the needle is covered by the auto-injector.
6. The auto-injector of claim 5, wherein a distal end of the auto-injector defines a distal opening and has an exterior tapered profile, the exterior tapered profile having a dimension that varies along a longitudinal axis of the auto-injector.
7. The auto-injector of claim 5, wherein the first and second sleeves are axially movable relative to one another.
8. The auto-injector of claim 5, wherein the first sleeve has a first axially-extending portion, the second sleeve has a second axially-extending portion, and the housing has a third-axially extending portion.
9. The auto-injector of claim 8, wherein a distal end of the second axially-extending portion is larger than a distal end of the first axially-extending portion.
10. The auto-injector of claim 8, wherein the auto-injector is configured to allow the first axially-extending portion of the first sleeve to be inside the second axially-extending portion of the second

sleeve.

11. The auto-injector of claim 5, wherein the auto-injector is configured such that after the injection process, the auto-injector can be withdrawn from the injection site such that a compression spring relaxes to cause the needle to be covered by the auto-injector.
 12. The auto-injector of claim 5, wherein the auto-injector is configured to provide a tactile feedback in a form of a resistance for allowing a patient to distinguish two steps of the injection process.
 13. The auto-injector of claim 5, comprising a syringe containing the medicament and comprising the needle, wherein the medicament comprises a glucagon-like peptide-1 (GLP-1) or an analogue or derivative thereof.
 14. An auto-injector comprising: a housing; a first sleeve comprising a first indicator of a first color, the first sleeve configured to move relative to the housing while remaining concentric to the housing; and a second sleeve comprising a second indicator of a second color different than the first color, the first sleeve configured to move relative to the second sleeve while remaining concentric to the second sleeve, the first sleeve extending axially from the second sleeve, and a distal end of the second sleeve being larger than a distal end of the first sleeve, wherein the auto-injector is configured such that when the auto-injector is pressed against an injection site, the distal end of the second sleeve touches the injection site, and the auto-injector can insert a needle into the injection site and deliver a medicament, wherein the first indicator and the second indicator are indicative of an injection process of the auto-injector, and wherein the housing comprises a latch member, and the first sleeve comprises a groove configured to receive the latch member to lock the first sleeve in a position relative to the housing in which a distal needle tip of the needle is covered by the auto-injector.
 15. The auto-injector of claim 14, wherein a distal portion of the auto-injector has an exterior tapered profile with a dimension that varies along a longitudinal axis of the auto-injector.
 16. The auto-injector of claim 15, wherein a proximal portion of the auto-injector that extends distally from the distal portion of the auto-injector is substantially cylindrical.
 17. The auto-injector of claim 14, wherein the first and second sleeves are axially movable relative to one another.
 18. The auto-injector of claim 14, wherein the first sleeve has a first axially-extending portion, the second sleeve has a second axially-extending portion, and the housing has a third-axially extending portion, and a distal end of the second axially-extending portion is larger than a distal end of the first axially-extending portion.
 19. The auto-injector of claim 18, wherein the auto-injector is configured to allow the first axially-extending portion of the first sleeve to be inside the second axially-extending portion of the second sleeve.
 20. The auto-injector of claim 14, wherein the auto-injector is configured such that after the injection process, the auto-injector can be withdrawn from the injection site such that a compression spring relaxes to cause the needle to be covered by the auto-injector.
 21. The auto-injector of claim 20, wherein the auto-injector is configured to provide a tactile feedback for allowing a patient to distinguish two steps of the injection process.
 22. The auto-injector of claim 14, comprising a syringe containing the medicament and comprising the needle, wherein the medicament comprises a glucagon-like peptide-1 (GLP-1) or an analogue or derivative thereof.
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